APPROVED ON OCTOBER 14, 2026
BY THE BOARD OF COUNTY COMMISSIONERS
AT THE WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION

County Administration Workshop: October 6, 2026
1:30 p.m. – Board of Commissioners Conference Room
Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. **Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest**

   Commissioners Richardson, Martin, and Smith each declared no potential conflicts of interest.

2. **Department Business**

   a. **Legal Counsel**

      1. **Resolution No. 2026-037 – In the Matter of Fair Housing in Josephine County**

Helene Lulich, Property Manager, presented Resolution No. 2026-037 renewing the County's fair housing resolution. She explained that the action is required as part of the County's Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) fair-housing activity and will assist with closing out the current two-year grant. The current grant totals $500,000 and has primarily supported home-repair assistance for low-income residents. The next $500,000 award includes approximately $400,000 for qualifying home repairs and $100,000 specifically for mobile homes located in mobile-home parks outside the City of Grants Pass. The CDBG funds originate with HUD and are administered through the State of Oregon. Home Bridging performs the repair work, and the County submits eligible costs to the State for reimbursement.

Ms. Lulich advised that, unless the Board designated another representative, she would serve as the County's fair housing representative for the required public notice. Without objection, the Board directed that Resolution No. 2026-037 be placed on the October 14, 2026 Weekly Business Session agenda, with Ms. Lulich to provide a public overview of the requirement and program.

   b. **Juvenile Justice**

      1. **Cancellation of the Child Nutrition Program Sponsor Agreement – Request for authorization for Community Justice Director Scott Hyde to provide a 60-day cancellation notice to the Child Nutrition Program, with cancellation effective no later than December 2026**

Scott Hyde, Community Justice Director, requested authorization to discontinue participation in the Child Nutrition Program Sponsor Agreement for the detention and residential programs. He reported that fiscal year 2025-26 food reimbursement totaled $13,748 against approximately $23,618 in food costs, while staff estimated that administration of the program required substantially more in personnel time, training/travel, and periodic audit preparation. Mr. Hyde also explained that program rules restrict portion sizes and purchasing options, limiting flexibility to provide additional healthy food and to select more cost-effective food sources. The department budgets approximately $36,000 annually for food and can absorb the food costs while redirecting staff time to other program needs.

Commissioner Richardson moved to authorize Community Justice Director Scott Hyde to provide a 60-day cancellation notice for the Child Nutrition Program Sponsor Agreement, with cancellation effective no later than December 2026. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

   c. **Prevention**

      1. **Grant – OJJDP FY 2026 Community and Schools Youth Drug Prevention Program – Approval to submit the grant proposal and designate Shawn Martinez as the authorized County representative for submission and implementation**

Scott Hyde, Community Justice Director, requested authorization to submit an application for the OJJDP FY 2026 Community and Schools Youth Drug Prevention Program. If awarded, the grant would provide $750,000

over three years, or approximately $250,000 annually. The department anticipates using the funding to support approximately 1 to 1.5 school outreach officer positions focused on Grants Pass School District 7, primarily at the high school with some middle-school availability. The proposal would also include a partnership with youth prevention educator Ray Lozano and his nonprofit program to strengthen education and prevention activities in Josephine County. Shawn Martinez would serve as the authorized County representative for submission and implementation.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve submission of the grant proposal and designate Shawn Martinez as the authorized County representative for submission and implementation. Commissioner Smith seconded the motion. Commissioner Richardson stated that, because the proposal specifically involved District 7 and school outreach officers, he would abstain. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Abstain; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 2-0.

d. **Sheriff**

1. **Unclaimed Property – Request to credit $57,100.39 in unclaimed currency and unclaimed property auction proceeds to the Sheriff's Office equipment reserve account (482935) for the purchase of replacement Tasers (Josephine County Code 2.80.060)**

Sheriff Dave Daniel requested that $57,100.39 in unclaimed currency and unclaimed-property auction proceeds be credited to the Sheriff's Office equipment reserve account for future replacement Tasers. Sheriff Daniel explained that the existing Tasers are becoming obsolete and increasingly difficult to support, and that a full replacement package is expected to cost approximately $500,000 for about 50 units under a multi-year technology contract. The Sheriff's Office has also received a $30,000 grant from the Cow Creek Band of Umpqua Tribe of Indians/Seven Feathers toward the replacement effort and is building the reserve so the County can plan for the eventual purchase.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the request to credit $57,100.39 in unclaimed currency and unclaimed-property auction proceeds to the Sheriff's Office equipment reserve account (482935) for replacement Tasers pursuant to Josephine County Code 2.80.060. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

2. **BJA FY 2026 Edward Byrne Memorial Justice Assistance Grant (JAG) Program – Local Formula – Approval to submit a grant application for $13,114.00 the full local allocation, to fund Deputy overtime for community engagement activities; the grant requires Board review and an opportunity for public comment**

Sheriff Dave Daniel presented the BJA FY 2026 Edward Byrne Memorial Justice Assistance Grant (JAG) Program local allocation in the amount of $13,114. The Sheriff intends to use the funding for overtime associated with renewed resident-deputy/community-engagement activities, including evening and weekend events. He described a plan to reestablish a resident-deputy style program with deputies serving Cave Junction, the northern portion of the County, and the southern portion of the County. The grant requires Board review and an opportunity for public comment.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve moving forward with the BJA FY 2026 Edward Byrne Memorial Justice Assistance Grant (JAG) Program application for the full local allocation of $13,114. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0. The Board directed that the grant be placed on the October 14, 2026 Weekly Business Session agenda to provide the required opportunity for public review and comment.

e. **Human Resources**

1. Position Requisition
    a. IT – System Support Specialist – Add one (1) Position – Approved in July Budget
    b. Public Health Animal Shelter – Shelter Technician – Add one (1) part-time position
    c. Public Health – Public Health Nurse Practitioner Jail Clinic – Change Current Job Description and Compensation Study
2. Personnel Actions
    a. IT – Technology Director – Promotion and Title Change
    b. Public Health – Program Specialist – Solid Waste – Re-hire
3. Telework Request
    a. Legal – Temporary Teleworking Approval

Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director, presented the listed position requisitions. The IT System Support Specialist position was approved in the July budget and is now ready to be filled following completion of the Technology Director hiring process. The Animal Shelter request adds one 0.7 FTE Shelter Technician supported by levy funding. Human Resources also requested an updated job description and compensation study for the Public Health Nurse Practitioner position serving the jail clinic; the description had not been updated since the County transitioned the jail medical staffing model from contracted services to County employment in 2023. In response to a Board question, Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe said she was not aware of a completed cost-effectiveness review of that change and that Public Health would be the appropriate department to address the program history.

Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe also presented personnel actions for the IT Technology Director and the Public Health Program Specialist - Solid Waste. She explained that the IT action completes the hiring process and transitions the position from interim status to the permanent director role, subject to the six-month trial-service period in County policy. The Solid Waste candidate is a former County employee with direct solid-waste and code-enforcement experience; Public Health requested a higher starting rate based on that prior experience. The Board also discussed that solid-waste revenues will be directed to the solid-waste program rather than the general fund so that program staffing and related costs can be supported by those revenues.
For the Legal Counsel telework request, Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe explained that the office HVAC system is not functioning adequately and the workspace has no operable windows. Because propping doors open creates security and confidentiality concerns, Human Resources proposed temporary telework under the existing personnel policy until the HVAC system is repaired, tentatively by October 16. The request applies to the Legal Counsel office staff, while counsel will continue attending meetings as needed. The Board raised no objection, and Human Resources indicated the temporary agreements would be processed through the existing telework procedure.

3. **OTHER**

None heard.

4. **ADDITIONAL SUBJECT MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS/ANNOUNCEMENTS:**

Commissioners Richardson and Martin reported no announcements. Chair Smith stated that the County appeared to be nearing the end of fire season, although several small fires had recently started, and noted that additional rain - particularly the typical November rains - would likely signal the end of the season.

Chair Smith adjourned the meeting at 2:03 p.m.